Saint Edward High School vs. St. Ignatius	1/3/2026	Prepared by: Coach Donelon

St. Ignatius enters our contest with an overall record of 6–3, coming off a challenging stretch in which they lost three of four games at the Torrey Pines Holiday Classic. Offensively, they are not running the same volume or variety of sets that they have in recent seasons. Instead, they rely heavily on Zoom action, middle ball screens, Loop (Iverson) cuts, and a heavy dose of isolation basketball. They want to play downhill, generate advantages one-on-one, and get out in transition, so our focus must be on floor balance and limiting them to one shot per possession. On the defensive end, St. Ignatius primarily plays man-to-man in the half court, but they have shown some 2-3 zone and occasional 1-3-1. They will also mix in 2-2-1 and 1-2-2 pressure, though the pressure is not as effective as in past years, as they do not rotate or recover out of it particularly well. We must handle pressure with composure, spacing, and decisiveness, play with swagger, and impose our will — we are the better team and need to play like it from start to finish.

Favorite Sets	Last 2 Minute Sets/ Special Situations
LOOP - IVERSON CUT	BLOB - 1-4 LOW TO S+S
ZOOM ACTION	BLOB - BOX
MIDDLE BALL SCREEN	BLOB - BOX TO WEAKSIDE STAGGER
ISO ACTION	LOOP
SWIPE	ZOOM
PISTOL	ISO BALL

Offensive Tendencies	Defensive Tendencies
17.3 3PT ATTEMPTS PER GAME	PRIMARILY WILL LOOK TO PLAY MAN TO MAN IN THE HALF COURT
38.5% FROM 3PT AS TEAM	1-3-1 defense and some 2-3 zone
9.3 OFF REBOUNDS PER GAME	1-2-2 - Will look to trap over half court
11.2 TURNOVERS PER GAME	Post Defense: Slip front and play behind
11.6 FTA PER GAME	Middle ball screen - No switch
69.5% FT	Weak side action - Lock + Trail
HEAVY ISO BALL	Have shown some trapping over half
ZOOM ACTION	Have switched on wing

Strengths	Weaknesses
SIZE	ISO BALL
ABILITY TO SCORE	BENCH PRODUCTION
TRANSITION OFFENSE	2ND-3RD ROTATIONS
ABILITY TO SCORE OFF TURNOVERS	
GUARD PLAY	

LAST FIVE GAMES

Date	Opponent	Score	Leading Scorer	Leading Rebounds	Leading Assists
12/30	Poly (CA)	60 - 41 W	#2 - 15 points	#22 - 5 rebs	#11 - 5 assists
12/29	De La Salle (CA)	75 - 58 L	#2 - 14 points	#35 - 5 rebs	#4 - 2 assists
12/27	Francis Parker (CA)	86 - 78 L	#3 - 27 points	#35 - 5 rebs	#4/11 - 4 assists
12/26	Jserra Catholic (CA)	71 - 70 L	#3 - 19 points	2/35 - 5 rebs	#2 - 5 assists
12/9	St. Vincent-St. Mary	61 - 52 W	#25 - 17 points	#2/25 - 7 rebs	#2 - 4 assists

Keys To Victory		
	PLAY WITH COMPOSURE	MOVE WITHOUT THE BALL
	TRANSITION DEFENSE	HANDLE PRESSURE
	LIMIT TO ONE SHOT	PLAY WITH ENERGY AND SWAG

Thoughts for the game

PLAY ST. EDWARD HIGH SCHOOL BASKETBALL

GUYS TO FOUL IN LATE GAME SITUATION	GUYS TO AVOID FOULINIG
#4 - #25	#3 - #2 - #35

STARTERS

RIGHTY			**SOPH**	7.4 PPG	**PRIMARY PG - DRIVE 1st**	
#4 Denahi Melton	**6'0**			58.3% FT	LIMIT PAINT TOUCHES - LOCATE EARLY	

Denahi is an explosive guard with very good handles and strong court vision who consistently puts pressure on the defense. He can finish going LEFT or RIGHT at the rim and is comfortable scoring through contact, frequently using a floater or euro step in traffic. Denahi moves well without the ball, cutting to the rim and finding scoring opportunities.

Offensively, 23.3% of his field-goal attempts have come from three, where he is shooting 28.6%. He is capable of making shots both catch-and-shoot and off the dribble. Defensively, Denahi is an aggressive on-ball defender who looks to jump passing lanes and create disruption.

Areas to exploit include a tendency for careless one-handed passes that lead to turnovers, and moments where frustration shows when plays don't go his way. He is prone to gambling on slot-to-slot and wing passes, lacks consistent gap discipline, and can lose his man in double-gap situations. When blitzed, he can be rash, often looking for the first escape if he can't split the double—sometimes putting a big in a tough spot.

RIGHTY			**SENIOR**	13.7 PPG	**HIGH VOLUME 3PT**	
#3 Alex Mack	**6'3**			77.8% FT	CONTEST HIS SHOTS - FORCE HIM LEFT	

Alex is a HIGH-VOLUME three-point shooter, with 64.9% of his field-goal attempts coming from beyond the arc, where he is converting at a strong 44.4% on the season. He is sneaky athletic and does a good job playing without the ball—cutting hard to the rim and crashing the glass to create extra possessions. With the ball, Alex can become turnover-prone when he tries to do too much, as he will over-dribble, struggle making plays out of traps, fail to play off two feet, and be loose with the ball at times. Off the dribble, he looks to pull up for jump shots and can get into ISO mode, where his efficiency drops. On the RIGHT block, he will attack baseline or square up for a fade-away jumper. Overall, he is less efficient scoring off the dribble, prefers to finish going RIGHT, and when forced to put the ball on the floor with his LEFT, he will drift on pull-up threes, making it critical that we run him off the line and force him left.

RIGHTY			**SENIOR**	14.8 PPG	**DRIVE 1ST**	
#2 RJ Jones	**6'6**			78.6% FT	NO PAINT TOUCHES - KEEP OFF GLASS	

RJ is a long, lanky, drive-first wing/forward who plays with high activity on both ends. He is most comfortable on the left wing, attacking gaps with an explosive first step, and prefers to finish going right, though he can drive either direction. From the left wing he will drive and spin back middle, and from the foul-line extended he can spin right or left. He moves well without the ball, cutting to the rim for dump-offs.

RJ will get into ISO mode and can take poor shots, especially from the right side in the mid-range or from three. Shooting is not his strength, as 17.2% of his FGA are from three, where he is shooting 20% (3-of-15), mainly when left open in the corner. We must keep him out of the paint, speed him up, locate him early in transition, and keep him off the offensive glass. Defensively, he is an active on-ball defender who creates steals and deflections. He will spin blindly in the paint, making him vulnerable to offensive fouls if a second defender steps in.

RIGHTY	**SOPH**	8.6 PPG	**DRIVE 1ST - GLASS**	
#25 Carlos Vaughn Jr.	**6'5**	60% FT	NO PAINT TOUCHES - KEEP OFF GLASS	

Carlos is an aggressive, drive-first guard with an explosive first step who consistently looks to attack off the catch. He does a good job of squaring up, using a head fake and jab step, and ripping downhill to create advantages. When he gets to the rim, he is capable of finishing both LEFT and RIGHT, but he heavily favors finishing RIGHT, which must be taken away.

While his game is built around paint touches and scoring off drive-and-dump opportunities, we must still be aware of him on the perimeter. Carlos has taken 16.9% of his field-goal attempts from three and is 5 of 9 (55.6%) on the season. However, this efficiency comes on limited volume, and he is not a consistent or proven perimeter threat. From memory, he will often settle for an early pull-up mid-range jumper or an early three rather than consistently putting pressure on the rim.

Defensively, the focus must be to keep him in front, eliminate paint touches, and keep him off the glass. Force him into pull-up jumpers and contested finishes, live with the early or rushed shot, and do not allow him to play downhill or get comfortable attacking gaps.

RIGHTY	**SENIOR**	4.1 PPG	**OFF GLASS - P+R - 3PT**	
#35 Keith Seide	**6'8**	75% FT	KEEP OFF GLASS - CLOSEOUT ON SHOT	

Keith is a primary POST presence for them and plays as a slow-footed BIG. In pick-and-roll action, he will roll hard to the basket, looking to score on rolls, drive-and-dump opportunities, and quick finishes, though he does not do a good job of squaring up to the rim. From the left wing, he will look to attack middle and will spin back baseline if cut off. On the right block, he prefers to attack baseline, while on the left block he wants to attack middle.

He is extremely active on the offensive glass, consistently looking for offensive put-backs, so he must be hit early and kept off the boards. While primarily an interior scorer, he will stretch the floor and step out to shoot from the perimeter—make him uncomfortable on catches and be ready to close out. On the season, 34.2% of his field-goal attempts have come from three, and he is 4-of-12 from deep (33.3%), so contest without fouling and force him to put the ball on the floor.

Thoughts for the game

PLAY ST. EDWARD HIGH SCHOOL BASKETBALL

GUYS TO FOUL IN LATE GAME SITUATION	GUYS TO AVOID FOULINIG
#11 - #5 - #24 - #34	#22

BENCH

RIGHTY — JUNIOR — 5.4 PPG — **BACKUP PG - 3PT**

#11 Sami Dari 6'2 — 60% FT — NO PAINT TOUCHES - CONTEST SHOTS

Sami serves as the backup point guard when he comes into the game and is capable of providing a steady offensive presence. He has strong handles, but can fall into a habit of over-dribbling, which can lead to careless turnovers when pressured. Offensively, he has the ability to drive both LEFT or RIGHT, but he is determined to finish RIGHT at all costs, often spinning back to his right hand or using a floater around the rim. He does not finish well through contact, making physicality important when he attacks the basket. From the perimeter, he has become a more efficient shooter this season, shooting 7-of-13 from three-point range (53.8%), with 41.9% of his field-goal attempts coming from beyond the arc. Defensively, we must keep him in front, eliminate paint touches, and contest every outside look—do not let him get comfortable with his rhythm jump shots.

LEFTY — SENIOR — 4.4 PPG — **HIGH VOLUME 3PT**

#5 Joe Maloof 6'0 — 60% FT — RUN OFF LINE - FORCE HIM RIGHT

Joe has provided a spark off the bench with his energy and activity. He does a good job of moving without the ball, cutting hard to the rim, and will use a EURO step to finish when he gets downhill. When driving RIGHT, he tends to settle for a pull-up jump shot, while he prefers to drive LEFT to finish at the rim. He is not strong going to his right, his handle can be shaky, and he can be pressured into turnovers with physical on-ball defense. Joe is a high-volume three-point shooter, with 55.8% of his field-goal attempts coming from three, and is primarily a catch-and-shoot threat from the perimeter. We must be prepared to run him off the line, force him to put the ball on the floor, and FORCE HIM RIGHT.

RIGHTY — FROSH — 0 PPG — **ROLE PLAYER - 3PT**

#24 Jordan Fortino 6'1 — NO ATT — RUN OFF LINE - ACTIVE HANDS ON BALL

This freshman has seen limited playing time and enters our game with very limited action this season. Offensively, his impact has been minimal, with 40% of his shot attempts coming from beyond the arc—he is currently 0-for-2 from three, indicating a clear perimeter-only role at this stage. Defensively, we must be locked in on closeouts, prepared to run him off the line, and be physical to disrupt his rhythm. With the ball, he can be loose at times, so active hands and ball pressure are critical, as he can be forced into turnovers when sped up.

RIGHTY — SENIOR — 1.6 PPG — **OFF GLASS - DUMP OFFS**

#22 Tristan Watkins 6'3 — 100% FT — KEEP OFF GLASS - WALL UP

Tristan is a role player whose offensive production primarily comes from drive-and-dump opportunities and second-chance points. He needs to be at the rim to score and has not attempted a three-point shot this season, making him a non-factor as a perimeter threat. Where he can hurt you is on the offensive glass, as he is extremely active and looks to generate extra possessions with put-backs.

On the defensive end, Tristan does not move his feet well laterally, and this can be exploited by attacking him off the bounce. We can put pressure on him by driving the ball, which should allow us to draw fouls and get him into foul trouble. The key is to keep him off the offensive boards and not allow him to become an X-factor by impacting the game with energy plays and second-chance points.

RIGHTY — SENIOR — 0 PPG — **ROLE PLAYER - POST**

#34 Henry Widdowson 6'5 — 0% FT — MATCH HIS ENERGY - DRIVE ON HIM

Henry is a role player who looks to impact the game primarily through effort and physicality rather than skill. Offensively, he will look to attack the middle from the left block, but he is not strong with his handles and struggles when double teamed, making him susceptible to turnovers and rushed decisions. He is active on the glass, which is where he creates most of his value, so we must hit first and keep him off the boards. Defensively, he is not extremely quick, allowing us to drive the ball on him, and he is prone to getting blown by on closeouts. Overall, the key is to match his energy, be physical, and limit his rebounding impact.